

ZACHARY ELLERBROOK

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Cybersecurity | Active Secret Clearance | U.S. Navy Veteran (2027)

SUMMARY

Navy senior enlisted leader (E-6, 24 years) serving as command IT Service Technician and Security Manager Liaison, transitioning to a full-time cybersecurity role. Owns network access administration and personnel-security tracking for a 40-person organization — SAAR-N authorization requests, clearance tracking, file-share permissions, PII handling — backed by hands-on Linux administration, a home pentesting lab, and a Python log-analysis tool built from scratch. Active Secret clearance (Tier 3R, adjudicated Jan 2023, Continuous Evaluation). SkillBridge-available from late February 2027; separates 30 June 2027.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security: Access control & authorization review (SAAR-N) · Personnel security & clearance administration · PII handling (Privacy Act) · Log analysis · SOC fundamentals (TryHackMe SOC Level 1) · Network fundamentals (Fortinet) · Vulnerability & exploitation basics (Kali, Metasploit — lab)

Systems: Linux (Arch/CachyOS daily driver, EndeavourOS, Ubuntu Server) · Windows 10/11 · Microsoft 365 / NMCI Flank Speed · VirtualBox

Tools & languages: Python · Bash · Git/GitHub · pytest · SharePoint permissions administration

EXPERIENCE

IT Service Technician & Security Manager Liaison — U.S. Navy, Navy Band Great Lakes, IL

Jan 2026 – Present (IT support duties since 2024)

- Designated NMCI Telecommunications Officer and Security Manager Liaison — sole point of contact for network access and personnel-security administration for a 35-40-person command.
- Review SAAR-N system authorization requests for completeness, accuracy, and correct access level; submit and track MAC actions through NMCI to completion.
- Submit and track SharePoint and file-share permission requests on behalf of command personnel, verifying need-to-know before routing — applying least-privilege in practice.
- Track command-wide security clearance expirations and maintain personnel rosters; screen access packages against clearance status and route to the NSTC Security Manager for SF-86 adjudication.
- Handle and safeguard PII including SSNs throughout the access-request lifecycle in accordance with the Privacy Act.
- Perform endpoint support: OS updates on 9 NMCI assets, provisioning of 9 peripherals, and NMCI asset inventory maintenance.

Operations Coordinator — U.S. Navy, Navy Band Great Lakes, IL

2025 – 2026 · also 2019 – 2020

- Directed the operations department for a 40-person organization across an 11-state area: processed 128 requests into 111 executed missions reaching audiences of 327,000.
- Authored 45 recurring reports per year to Navy leadership (SECNAV weekly, outreach, Echelon-2 monthly), maintaining executive visibility of unit activity.
- Designed and delivered technical and professional training to groups of 30+ — one of eight years of formal instruction across the career.

Command Pay & Personnel Administrator — U.S. Navy, Navy Band Southwest, San Diego, CA

Nov 2020 – Sep 2022

- Ran pay, personnel, and travel records administration for a 45-member activity outside own specialty; processed 140 system transactions and 21 gain/loss packages with sustained accuracy in a records system holding PII for every member.
- Earned the A16A Command Pay & Personnel Administrator classification; Sailor of the Quarter, 3rd Qtr FY21.

Earlier U.S. Navy assignments — 2002 - 2020

Navy Recruiter (NRD Chicago, 2014–2017; Advanced Recruiter, 7 Gold Wreath awards) · Command Leading Petty Officer, 36 personnel · Fiscal Petty Officer, Government Purchase Card program (107 requests, zero discrepancies) · Command Career Counselor (98% retention) · Supply Petty Officer (\$250K inventory, 100% accountability) · Safety/ESAMS supervisor · Public Affairs supervisor.

Naval Service Training Command Sailor of the Year, FY19 · Navy & Marine Corps Commendation Medal · 6 Navy & Marine Corps Achievement Medals.

PROJECTS

SSH Detect & Respond — Python · github.com/zellerbrook/ssh-detect-respond

Parses SSH authentication logs into structured events (timestamp, source IP, username, outcome) and tails live files — correctly surviving log rotation and in-place truncation, a failure mode where naive monitors go silently blind while still appearing healthy. pytest suite covers parsing, rotation, and truncation. Attack-detection logic in progress.

Home pentesting lab — VirtualBox: Kali Linux attacker VM against Metasploitable 2, Windows 7, and Windows 10 targets — enumeration, exploitation, and post-exploitation practice.

CERTIFICATIONS

Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate (2024) · Google IT Support Professional Certificate (2024) · Fortinet Networking Fundamentals (2025) · TryHackMe SOC Level 1 (2025) · TryHackMe Cyber Security 101 (2025) · ZTM Complete Python Developer (2026) · ZTM DevOps Bootcamp: Linux Sysadmin (2026) · Google AI Essentials (2024)

EDUCATION

M.S. Education — St. Joseph's College of Maine, 2013 (completed while serving full-time)

B.M. Jazz Performance — Southern Illinois University Edwardsville, 1999